

UIT-ISTAG OMNISPORT CAMPUS

UNIVERSITY OF EBOLOWA

PROFESSIONAL BACHELOR DEGREE PROGRAMME

**UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH REPORT WRITING AND PROJECT WRITING
GUIDELINES**

I. RESEARCH REPORT WRITING GUIDELINES

- Key Points

- i. Paper format: The report should be written on A4 size paper
- ii. Font type: The font type to be used should be Times New Roman
- iii. Size and Spacing: The font size should be 12 with 1.5-line spacing. The margin should be 1'' (2.5 cm) on top and bottom, $1\frac{1}{2}$ (3.5 cm) on the left and 1'' (2.5 cm) on the right.
- iv. Page numbering: The page number should be indicated on the bottom left while respecting the two format numbering system i.e. preliminary pages in Roman numerals and the other pages in Our numerals.

- Research Report Structure

The research report should have the following structure:

❖ ***Preliminary Pages***

- i. ***Title page (no page number)*** should contain the following:
 - Name/Logo of the university
 - Name/Logo of the school
 - Title of the research including subtitle if any below should follow
 - "Research Report Submitted in Partial Fulfilment for the Award of Professional Bachelors of (XXXXXXXXX specialty) Degree of University of Yaoundé II"
 - Student's information i.e. department/specialty, name and registration number
 - Academic and Professional Supervisors' names on the right and left respectively.
 - Academic Year

Note: Consult past reports to see practical layouts.

- ii. ***Declaration (page i: Roman numeral)***

This is done by the student to indicate that the work presented is original and has not been published or submitted elsewhere for the same or other purposes. Then signatures

- iii. ***Certification (Page ii: Roman numeral)***

To be done by the student then signed by the supervisor that the work presented is original and has not been published or submitted elsewhere for the same or other purposes.

- iv. **Dedication page (Page iii: Roman numeral)** The work is to be dedicated to one person or on group of persons.
- v. **Acknowledgements (Page iv: Roman numeral) one-page** appreciation of all those who contributed or have contributed in one way or the other starting with your supervisors, specialty lecturers, administrative staff, etc.
- vi. **List of figures (page v: Roman numeral).** In order of appearance with page numbers **Add only if any.**
- vii. **List of tables (if any. Page vi: Roman numeral)** in order of appearance with page numbers
- viii. **List of abbreviations/Acronyms.** *Abbreviation* a term used more than three times throughout the report. *Acronyms* abbreviations that can be pronounced as a word e.g. BEAC.
- ix. **Abstract (maximum 280 words)** it should contain *purpose of the study, methodology, results, and main recommendations*. Conclude with **Keywords ...**
- x. **Table of contents** shouldn't be done manually.

❖ **CHAPTER ONE: Introduction** (*Apply past tense where required*)

- 1.1.**Background of the Study** (min. 5 pages up to 6 pages) *citations needed
- 1.2.**Statement of Problem** (1/2 to ¾ page max) *citations needed
- 1.3.**Research Questions** (1 main and at least 02 specific)
- 1.4.**Research Objectives** (1 main and at least 02 specific objectives)
- 1.5.**Research Hypothesis** at least two specific research hypotheses more preferably the null
- 1.6.**Significance of the Study.** The significance should be done to The managers of the firm as well similar firms, Future researchers and Literature (2 paragraphs)
- 1.7.**Scope of the Study.** Present the geographical, thematic and time scope
- 1.8.**Organisation of the Study.** State the number of chapters that make up the study and briefly state what will be treated in each of these chapters.

❖ **CHAPTER TWO: Literature Review (min 22 pages, max 24pages)** *citations needed

2.1. Conceptual Review : explain your independent variable and your dependent variable

2.1.1. Your independent variable (definition, form and importance)

2.1.2. Your dependent variable (definition, factors affecting it, its dimensions/measures)

2.2. Thematic Review: present here two to four theories max linking your two variables

2.3. Empirical Review: Present past authors in your topic, their works and findings

2.4. Presentation of internship activities: Talk about the name of the enterprise, the history of the enterprise, the legal status of the enterprise, products and services, organisational structure, the department you worked in and the activities you carried out, the challenges faced and the practical knowledge you gained.

❖ CHAPTER THREE: Methodology (in past tense), 5 pages or 6 max

3.1. Study Design: present and justify the research design, method, and approach adopted for the study *citations needed.

3.2. Study Populations and Sampling Techniques *citations needed

3.2.1. **Target Population:** Precise those from whom you collected the study data

3.2.2. **Sample Size and Sampling Technique:** State the number of people you collected the data from and justify the sampling technique (simple random, convenient, purposive, etc.?) you used to select these individuals from the total population

3.3. Data Collection Procedure: Present the sources of data you used and the instruments used to collect the data.

3.4. Data Analysis Procedure and Estimation Techniques: Talk on the Software used to code and analyse the data, precise the descriptive statistics used and the estimation technique (correlation and simple regression) to test the hypotheses.

3.5. Ethical Consideration: Precise how you avoided plagiarism, violation of respondents' consents and faulty findings.

❖ CHAPTER FOUR: Presentation and Discussion of Findings (From 8 to 10 pages)

4.1. Descriptive statistics/demographic characteristics of respondents

4.2. Inferential statistics and test of hypothesis. **Show the results of each test and present the findings for each of your specific research question/hypothesis.*

❖ CHAPTER FIVE: Discussion of findings, Conclusion and Recommendation
(between 6 and 10 pages)

5.1. Summary and Discussion of Findings say what your findings are for each hypothesis/specific research question.

Note: Indicate

- Two to three authors in past (empirical review) with same findings like yours for the specific research questions/hypotheses
- Two to three authors whose findings contradict yours

5.2. Conclusion (1/2 page) do a recall of what the study sorted to do and the resultant outcome.

5.3. Recommendation (1/2 page) suggest what management should do based on your findings

5.4. Limitation of the study state what was not done or poorly done in the study which is important.

5.5. Area for future research what could be taken into consideration by anyone (including you) who is working on a similar topic in future

➤ **References** (min. 15 references)

- Do well to present all the citations used in the study on the references
- Use the American Psychological Association (APA) Reference style. *Use the 6th or 7th edition.

➤ **Appendices**

- All tools used during data collection (e.g. questionnaire), consent forms in English and in French if needed
- Mode of response or call up for internship e.g. Oral call, mail, etc.
- Scanned copy of the internship attestation
- Scanned photo of the internship location

VERY VERY IMPORTANT!!!!

The total number of pages counting from page 1 of chapter 1 is minimum 52 pages and maximum 65pages

II. PROJECT OR BUSINESS PLAN PRESENTATION GUIDELINES

❖ PRELIMINARY PAGES

- i. **Page title** name of the schools, university, title of the project, etc.
- ii. **Table of contents**
- iii. **Executive summary** should contain
 - A brief overview of the company: the missions and vision of the company. i.e. products services you are offering, the need that they are satisfying, the target audience of the products
 - Your competitive strategy in the market
 - Legal status of the business
 - Management body and their qualification
 - Capital of the business
 - Location and justification
 - Purpose of the presentation

❖ CHAPTER ONE: The Business

1.1. Presentation of the business

- **History of the business:** Name of the business and the its origin. State the problem/need you are trying to solve or satisfy that lead to the creation of the firm, explain why it is a problem, what is the solution? Explain why is a great solution. *You are presenting the details on the *company's mission, vision, set of objectives to be achieved* and the *strategy*.
- **Legal status:** what kind of company is it? Is it a sole proprietorship, partnership, corporation or limited liability company?
- **Capital structure:** what is the capital structure of the firm/company? Give the total required capital and its corresponding sources e.g. shares, social capital, personnel, loans, etc.
- **Organisation of the business:** give the enterprise organigram, the total number of employees précising the key or strategic personnel of the business. Describe them in terms of their names, qualification, training, experience, role, etc.
- **Environmental impact analysis:** present how your business will affect the general society. What will be its effect on the population (employment, better living standards etc...), on climate changes, eco-system. State the negative effect by emphasis on the positive effect.

1.2.Product/Service Offerings it should contain

- A detailed explanation of the product service: this will include details of your product features (use images to illustrate each product or service)
- Unique selling proposition, that is, the product benefits and differentials that persuade customers to buy (what makes your product unique)

❖ CHAPTER TWO: The Market

2.1.Market Analysis

2.1.1. Industrial/Market trend precisions on market/industry your business is. Present the history and evolution of the market. How is competition in this market (intense or normal)? What are the key successful factors of the market? Indicate how you plan to integrate these factors into your business model. Present the market size (the estimate population) and growth potential.

2.1.2. Target Market (Customers analysis)

- Present your actual and potential buyers (those you aim to sell your products to)
- Give an estimate of how many of them are there
- Precise the needs that your product or service is satisfying to these clients
- Precise the customers' expectations and desire your product will satisfy

2.1.3. Competitors' Analysis

- Present your direct competitors (those who sale the same products or services as you if they exist). How many of them are there? Which ones are the main strongest or weakest?
- Indicate your indirect competitors (sellers of substitute products)
- State clearly how you plan to compete or dominate with these competitors. That is your competitive analysis.

2.1.4. Suppliers and Distribution Analysis

- Who is the main supplier of your industry? Are there many or few? Present where you will buy the raw material and other components you need for production or sale. What is the advantage of buying from them?
- Will you distribute your product by yourself or you will use distributors? State them and how you will operate with them.

2.2.Environmental Analysis and the SWOT Matric

- Present current macro environmental factors (political, economic, socio-cultural, technological, ecological, and legal factors) that affect your business and the opportunities or threats they provide which your business will exploit or defend itself against.
- Analyse your business in terms of *financial resources, product quality, employees' skills and competences, type of equipment and machines, customer relationship*, and identify what you are best or weak as compared to rivals.

The SWOT Matric (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats)

- From the internal environmental analysis, identify the strength and weakness of your business
- From your external environmental analysis, identify the opportunities and threats of your business.

Note: Advisable to put this element in a table.

2.3.The Marketing Plan and Strategies

You are required to provide your market mix

- The marketing objectives
- Product policy
- Advertising and Promotion strategies
- Sales and Distribution strategies

❖ CHAPTER THREE: Operation Facilities and Infrastructures

3.1. Location Choice

Precise where the production operations and sales points will be located and justify why you choose this area. What is the advantage of locating there?

3.2. Production Operation and Facilities

Describe the process of fabricating and selling/distributing your product or your service, from how the raw material will be acquired, transported, treated and transformed into finished product, to warehousing, sales and distribution of final product to end users.

3.3. Infrastructures and Technologies

What machines, equipment, technologies, building or any other facilities will be used at each level of operations? (present all the production, transportation marketing and selling facilities and the total numbers)

3.4. Human Resources

Present the total number of employees for your firm, their tasks and responsibilities, their skills and competencies, as well as their experiences.

❖ CHAPTER FOUR: Financial Projections and Analysis

4.1. Financial Planning

- Present the **Total Capital** of the business and the corresponding sources
- **Present the cost projections** *i.e. the variable costs, the fixed cost and the total costs of the business*. Note the variable and fixed costs items should be well presented in a table. The sum gives the total cost of the business.

4.2. Financial Statement

- Income statement
- Balance sheet
- Cash flow statement

4.3. Break-even analysis: compare your sales to cost and state when the firm will break-even

4.4. Duration

- Project schedule
- Launch of marketing campaigns
- Time frame for each key milestone

ix. Conclusion

x. References

xi. Appendices

IMPORTANT NOTICE!!!!

The project should be between 25-30 pages. Emphasis should be laid on practical work